

The Watch

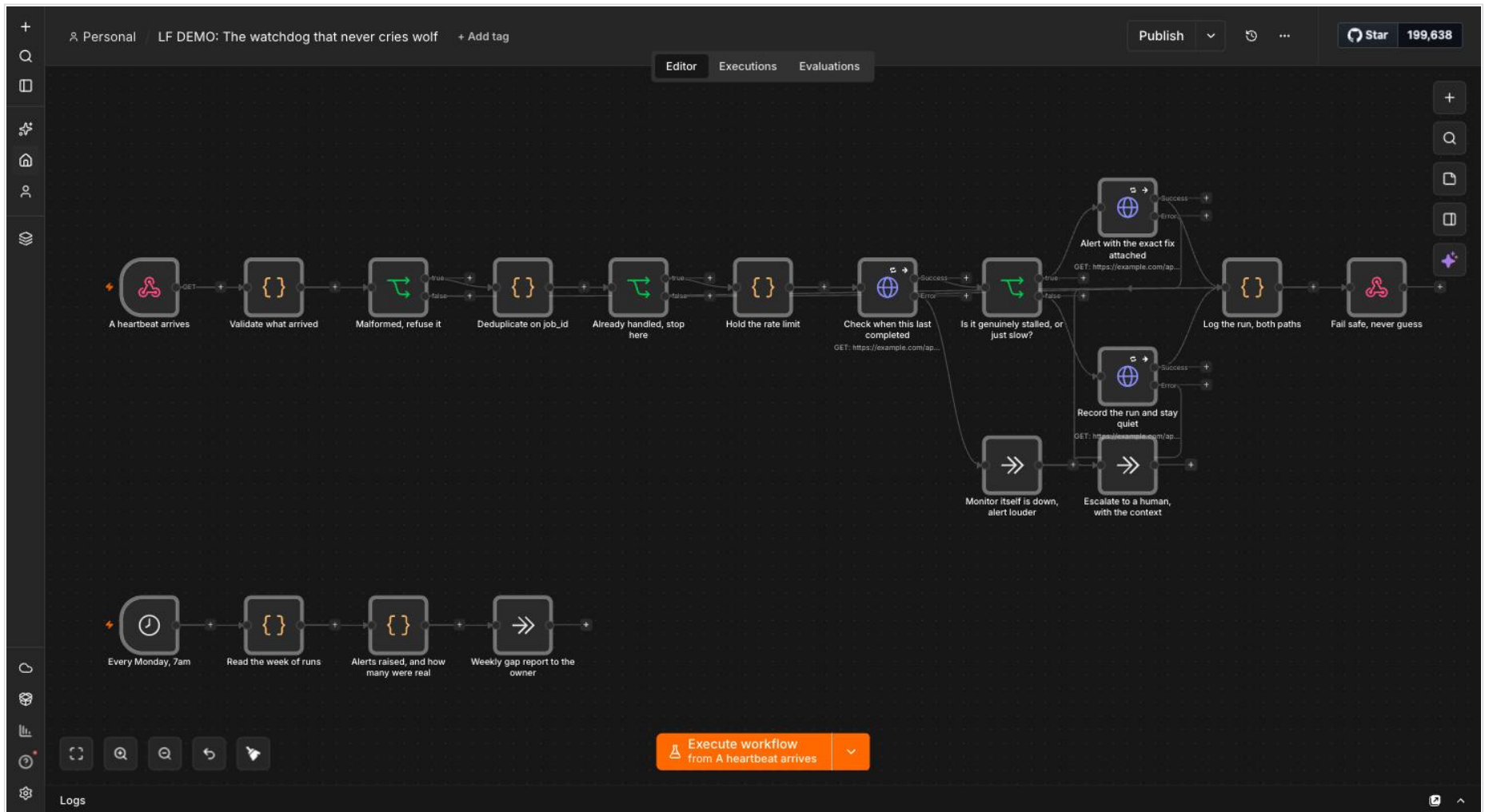
alerting · built in google-sheets

Something breaks silently and the business hears it from a customer. That's the most expensive way to find out.

What it connects to: The thing that breaks and the thing that tells you are never the same system, and the watchdog must not depend on the system it is watching.

1 of 4 SYSTEM

Here's the watchdog, with the exact fix carried inside the alert rather than just the symptom.



2 of 4 THINKING

It's tested against a planted failure before it ever watches anything real — an alert nobody trusts gets muted.

The screenshot shows a workflow editor interface for a node titled "Is it genuinely stalled, or just slow?". The interface is divided into three main sections: INPUT, Parameters, and OUTPUT.

INPUT Section: Displays "No input data" with a button "Execute previous nodes" and the text "to view input data".

Parameters Section: Contains tabs for "Parameters" and "Settings". Under "Parameters", there is a "Conditions" section with a JSON expression: `{{ $json.stalled === true && $json.minutesSince > $json.threshold }}`. A dropdown menu next to it shows "is true". Below the conditions is a button "+ Add condition". There is also a toggle switch for "Convert types where required" which is currently off. An "Options" section is visible with a button "+ Add option". An orange button "Execute step" is located at the top right of the Parameters section.

OUTPUT Section: Displays "No output data" with a button "Execute step" and the text "to view output data".

At the bottom of the interface, there is a "Logs" tab and a question mark icon with the text "I wish this node would...".

The alerting path in the CRM, escalating with context.

Apps Script

Job Intake and Bulk Order Aut...

Deploy

?

S

Executions

Showing 6 executions over last 7 days | Show in real time: ☒

+ Add a filter

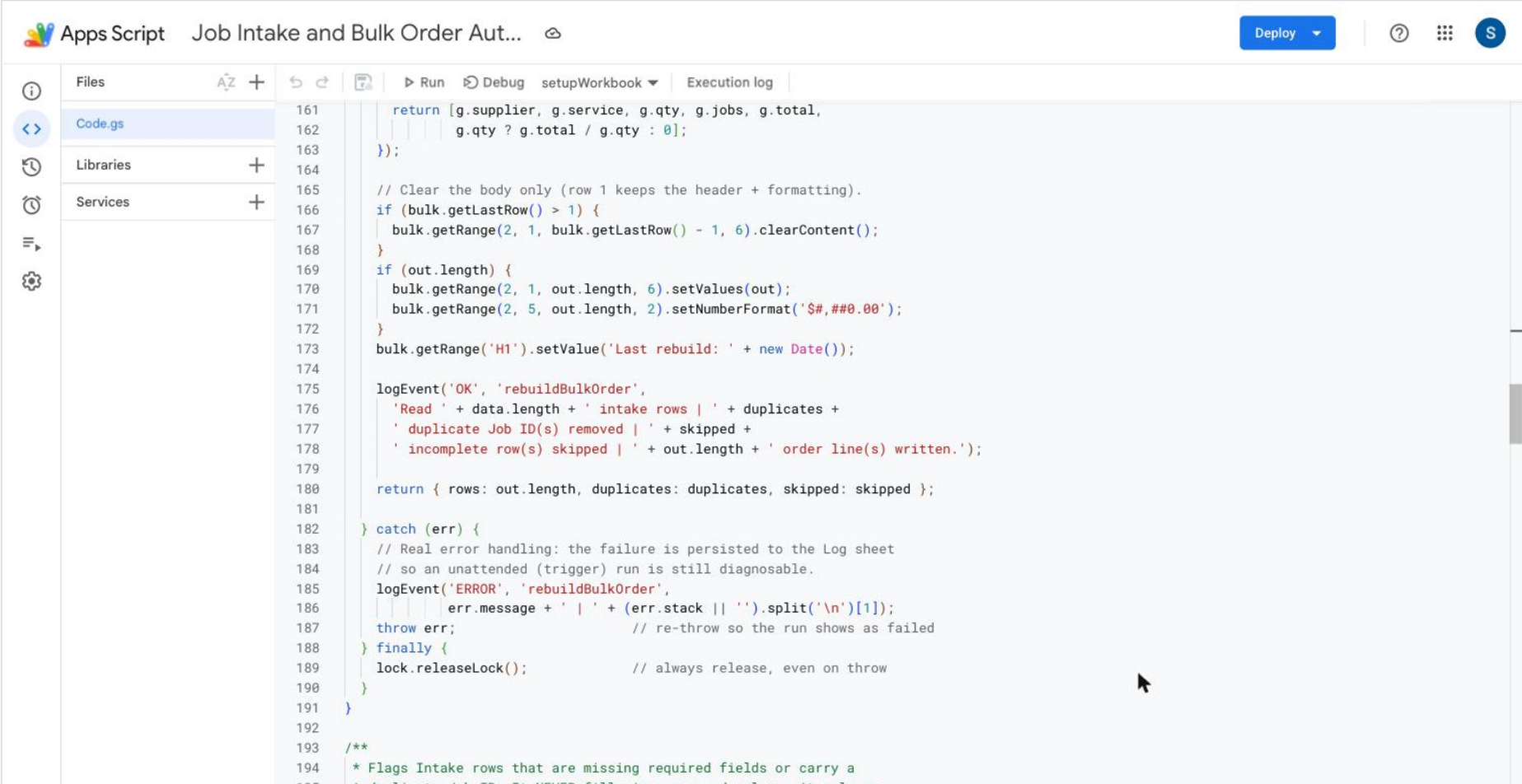
Deployment	Function	Type	Start Time	Duration	Status
Head	validateIntake	Menu	Aug 7, 2026, 8:17:07 PM	1.447 s	Completed
Head	rebuildBulkOrder	Menu	Aug 7, 2026, 8:16:36 PM	2.639 s	Completed
Head	onOpen	Simple Trigger	Aug 7, 2026, 8:15:59 PM	0.454 s	Completed
Head	setupWorkbook	Editor	Aug 7, 2026, 8:15:05 PM	4.172 s	Completed
Head	onOpen	Editor	Aug 7, 2026, 8:14:25 PM	0.455 s	Failed
Head	onOpen	Editor	Aug 7, 2026, 8:12:24 PM	1.315 s	Failed

Rows per page: 50

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4 of 4 RESULT

And the precision check: how many alerts were actually real.



The screenshot shows the Google Apps Script editor interface. The top bar includes the Google logo, the text "Apps Script", the project name "Job Intake and Bulk Order Aut...", and a "Deploy" button. Below the top bar is a sidebar with icons for information, code editor, libraries, services, and settings. The main editor area displays a JavaScript function with line numbers 161 through 194. The code includes a return statement, a comment about clearing the body, an if statement for clearing content, a loop for setting values and number formats, a logEvent call, and a finally block for releasing a lock. A mouse cursor is visible near the bottom right of the code area.

```
161     return [g.supplier, g.service, g.qty, g.jobs, g.total,  
162             g.qty ? g.total / g.qty : 0];  
163   });  
164  
165   // Clear the body only (row 1 keeps the header + formatting).  
166   if (bulk.getLastRow() > 1) {  
167     bulk.getRange(2, 1, bulk.getLastRow() - 1, 6).clearContent();  
168   }  
169   if (out.length) {  
170     bulk.getRange(2, 1, out.length, 6).setValues(out);  
171     bulk.getRange(2, 5, out.length, 2).setNumberFormat('$#,##0.00');  
172   }  
173   bulk.getRange('H1').setValue('Last rebuild: ' + new Date());  
174  
175   logEvent('OK', 'rebuildBulkOrder',  
176     'Read ' + data.length + ' intake rows | ' + duplicates +  
177     ' duplicate Job ID(s) removed | ' + skipped +  
178     ' incomplete row(s) skipped | ' + out.length + ' order line(s) written.');
```

```
179  
180   return { rows: out.length, duplicates: duplicates, skipped: skipped };  
181  
182 } catch (err) {  
183   // Real error handling: the failure is persisted to the Log sheet  
184   // so an unattended (trigger) run is still diagnosable.  
185   logEvent('ERROR', 'rebuildBulkOrder',  
186     err.message + ' | ' + (err.stack || '').split('\n')[1]);  
187   throw err; // re-throw so the run shows as failed  
188 } finally {  
189   lock.releaseLock(); // always release, even on throw  
190 }  
191 }  
192  
193 /**  
194 * Flags Intake rows that are missing required fields or carry a
```